

Tecno Pova Slim

Slim design, big battery, small price

Thin phones used to be the cool kids of the smartphone world until everyone

realised you can't live on salad forever and you need battery. Then came the era of chunky bricks with giant batteries, heavy camera bumps, and cases that made them even chunkier. But here we are in 2025, and thin is back in fashion.

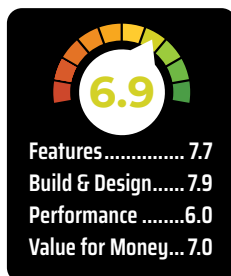
Samsung showed it off first with the S25 Edge. Apple raised the bar with the impossibly slim iPhone Air at 5.6 mm and in the midst of it, Tecno has thrown its hat in the ring with the Pova Slim.

But here's the twist: while iPhone Air can claim the slimmest, Tecno Pova Slim can confidently call itself the lightest, just 156g, all while squeezing in a 5160 mAh battery. So, is Tecno saying: you don't need to be a trillion-dollar company to build a phone that's thin, light, and practical? Probably yes. But is the Pova Slim worth that flex?

DESIGN

The first thing you notice when you pick up the Pova Slim is how absurdly light and thin it feels. Slide it into a jeans pocket and it practically disappears. It has a plastic frame, a fiberglass back and yet Tecno has done a good job of balancing the slimness with durability: Gorilla Glass 7i on the front, an IP64 splash resistance rating, and even MIL-STD-810H compliance for everyday bumps and drops. These are not features you normally associate with phones that look like supermodels, but when you've got a phone this thin, durability shouldn't be an afterthought. In fact, props to Tecno for providing a tempered glass in the box.

The curved AMOLED panel blends into the sides, and Tecno even sneaked in a glowing strip at the back that reacts to music, notifications, and charging.



It's playful, borderline gimmicky, but it adds a sense of character. The Pova Slim is available in Sky Blue, Slim White, and Cool Black and manages to feel more premium than its Rs 19,999 price tag suggests.

DISPLAY

The 6.78-inch AMOLED display is one of the strongest features of the Pova Slim. With a 1.5K resolution, 144Hz refresh rate, and a 240Hz touch sampling rate, it delivers sharpness, responsiveness, and fluidity in everyday use.

However, there's a caveat: the Dimensity 6400 SoC only natively supports 120Hz display and the higher 144Hz refresh rate mode is restricted to three apps: Settings, Messages and Phone. That limitation isn't a deal-breaker, but what stings more is the lack of HDR content support, which

holds the panel back from being a true all-rounder for streaming enthusiasts.

Brightness is where it truly shines: Tecno claims 4500 nits of peak brightness and our lab testing got 2600 nits in auto HBM mode, and visibility under harsh sunlight is genuinely impressive.

Our Calman analysis confirmed that Tecno's colour calibration here deliberately favours vibrancy over strict accuracy. Colours look lively and punchy without being overcooked, you get deep, inky blacks and the curved edges add that little extra flair. The panel covers 99.9% of the sRGB color space, so it has the range to reproduce almost everything modern apps, games, and video content can throw at it.

But the out-of-the-box tuning pushes saturation. Our average deltaE measured at 4 (lower is better, with <2 being imperceptible to the human eye). That explains why images look extra vivid, they're tuned to pop rather than to strictly adhere to natural colours. The RGB balance confirms a boosted blue channel, which gives whites a rather crisp, bluish tint.

This is a high-quality panel tuned to impress the average user. It's bright, punchy, and immersive in a way that instantly feels more premium than the phone's price suggests. It's a display that feels more at home on a Rs 30,000–Rs 35,000 device, and that elevates the Pova Slim's everyday experience far beyond its category.

PERFORMANCE

The phone is powered by the MediaTek's Dimensity 6400 processor, paired with 8GB LPDDR4x RAM and 128GB UFS 2.2 storage. On paper, this puts it in the comfortable mid-range zone and that's exactly how it performs:

- AnTuTu: 461,890
- Geekbench 5: 770 single-core / 2016 multi-core
- PCMark Work 3.0: 10,907
- 3DMark Wild Life: 1332

In everyday use, the phone handles multitasking, browsing, video streaming, and social apps without breaking a sweat. Where it starts to feel